

## MOTHERBOARDS

There have been continuous advancements in desktop technologies ranging from display to storage, to processors, stretching even to the RAM. All of these advancements are reflections of the new, futuristic motherboards.

### Across the board

For Intel processors, check if your motherboard supports either RDRAM or DDR memory. RDRAM offers greater bandwidth, while DDR is a good cost-effective solution and with the advent of DDR II memory, its performance is close to that of RDRAM. However, availability of this new memory is scarce and the full potential of these motherboards will not be realised until they are used with the compliant memory. The second most important factor is the type of processor supported. While the Pentium 4 Northwood is still Intel's most popular processor, there are others on the anvil that will support even greater clock speeds such as the new Pentium 4s with HyperThreading technology. Check if the motherboard supports these new processors, especially if you want to upgrade later. Even with AMD processors, evaluate whether the motherboard reflects the technology supported by the new processors, especially the Opteron.

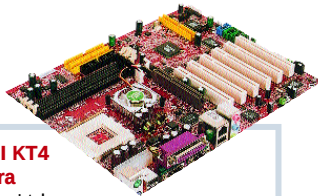
### And the award goes to...

The AMD motherboard that shattered our records in performance and utility was the MSI KT4 Ultra. With a host of features such as the new VIA KT400 chipset, support for DDR/333 memory, 8x AGP, a 200/266 MHz



**MSI KT4 Ultra**  
Priya Ltd,  
Ph: 022-22663611

**The verdict:** Based upon the formidable KT400 chipset, this motherboard features support for DDR memory, has six USB ports, six-channel onboard audio and serial ATA, making it the highest performance platform for AMD processors



| Nominees                 |                                                |                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name                     | Contacts                                       | Comments                                                                                                                              |
| <b>For AMD CPUs</b>      |                                                |                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>DFI AD70-SC/SR</b>    | Zeta Technologies,<br>Ph: 022-24102288         | Built around the KT266 chipset, motherboard features a bus speed support of up to 266 MHz and supports DDR memory                     |
| <b>DFI AD73 PRO</b>      | Zeta Technologies,<br>Ph: 022-24102288         | Sporting the KT266A chipset, motherboard also supports Pentium 4 processors, DDR memory along with ATAPI and IDE drives               |
| <b>For Intel CPUs</b>    |                                                |                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Intel D850MD</b>      | Nebula Technologies Pvt Ltd, Ph: 022-2673 0567 | This motherboard is based on the Intel D850GB chipset and supports PC800 RDRAM along with integrated Ethernet and audio functionality |
| <b>MSI 845E Max2-BLR</b> | Priya Ltd, Ph: 022-22663611                    | Built around the i845E chipset, motherboard supports a bus speed up to 533 MHz, supports DDR memory and also integrates Bluetooth     |

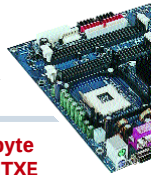
bus speed support and the inclusion of Bluetooth connectivity, this motherboard provides the fastest platform for AMD processors and has a host of connectivity and peripheral options.

The Intel motherboard that shone this year was the Gigabyte GA-8ITXE, based on the Intel D850GB chipset. With support for PC800 RDRAM, this implementation of the i850 family of chipset lets the Northwood P4 processors see their maximum performance levels.



**Gigabyte GA-8ITXE**  
Nebula Technologies Pvt Ltd,  
Ph: 022-2673 0567

**The verdict:** Built around the i850 chipset that supports a bus speed of 400 MHz and RDRAM support, this motherboard proved to be the fastest platform for Pentium 4 processors



## LINUX DISTRIBUTIONS

### Mandrake Linux 8.2

An immensely easy installation and an attractive interface makes Mandrake Linux 8.2 an excellent Linux distribution. Its ability to install to different profiles of application areas makes it ideal for users who don't want to install components of the OS they don't really need. This means that you can tailor your installation to a specific need such as gaming, Web server, e-mail server, multimedia authoring, office applications, etc. There are numerous wizards to help you with everything, from installation to loading and configuring hard-

ware and installing drivers. If you want to switch to Linux, Mandrake Linux 8.2 is a brilliant place to start for professionals who need an OS that offers tweakability, as well as for first-time adventures into the world of Linux.



**Mandrake Linux 8.2**  
G.T. Enterprise,  
Ph: 080-6606093

**The verdict:** With very comprehensive support for virtually every type of application and usage area, this Linux distribution is highly configurable and suited well to amateurs and seasoned users alike

